✦ BOTANICAL REFERENCE GUIDE ✦

Sacred & Ceremonial PLANTS

PLANTS OF HEALING TRADITIONS

White Sage
Salvia apiana

TRADITION
Lakota, Chumash, SW Native American

CEREMONY / USE
Smudging, space clearing, purification rituals

PROPERTIES
Antimicrobial (clears airborne bacteria), mood-elevating

SPIRITUAL SIGNIFICANCE
Carries prayers to spirit world; cleanses negative energy

Palo Santo
Bursera graveolens

TRADITION
Inca, Andean cultures

CEREMONY / USE
Smoke cleansing, spiritual protection, healing rituals

PROPERTIES
Antidepressant, analgesic, anti-inflammatory

SPIRITUAL SIGNIFICANCE
"Holy wood" — elevates energy, invites in the sacred

Copal
Bursera bipinnata

TRADITION
Maya, Aztec

CEREMONY / USE
Offerings to gods, funerary rites, healing ceremonies

PROPERTIES
Antibacterial, anti-inflammatory

SPIRITUAL SIGNIFICANCE
Bridge between worlds; "blood of trees" in Nahuatl cosmology

Ayahuasca
Banisteriopsis caapi

TRADITION
Amazonian shamanic traditions

CEREMONY / USE
Healing dieta, vision quests, deep psychological work

PROPERTIES
MAOI (harmala alkaloids), visionary

SPIRITUAL SIGNIFICANCE
"Vine of the soul" — access to ancestral knowledge and healing

Peyote
Lophophora williamsii

TRADITION
Huichol, Native American Church

CEREMONY / USE
Vision quests, healing circles, coming-of-age ceremonies

PROPERTIES
Mescaline — visionary, anti-anxiety, analgesic

SPIRITUAL SIGNIFICANCE
Grandfather cactus — teacher plant, divine communication

Cannabis
Cannabis sativa

TRADITION
Hindu, Rastafari, Scythian, ancient China

CEREMONY / USE
Meditation, devotional offerings, healing

PROPERTIES
THC/CBD — analgesic, anti-anxiety, visionary

SPIRITUAL SIGNIFICANCE
Sacred to Shiva; sacrament in multiple living traditions

Tobacco
Nicotiana rustica / tabacum

TRADITION
Pan-indigenous Americas

CEREMONY / USE
Prayer offerings, healing, treaty sealing

PROPERTIES
Nicotine — stimulant, emetic in high doses

SPIRITUAL SIGNIFICANCE
Messenger plant — carries intention; "first medicine" in many traditions

Blue Lotus
Nymphaea caerulea

TRADITION
Ancient Egypt

CEREMONY / USE
Funeral rites, festivals, visionary states

PROPERTIES
Aporphine, nuciferine — calming, mildly psychoactive

SPIRITUAL SIGNIFICANCE
Symbol of creation and the sun; the flower of Osiris

Fly Agaric
Amanita muscaria

TRADITION
Siberian shamanism, Norse, Vedic

CEREMONY / USE
Shamanic journeying, vision seeking

PROPERTIES
Muscimol — dissociative, visionary

SPIRITUAL SIGNIFICANCE
Doorway to spirit world; possible source of Soma in Rigveda

Damiana
Turnera diffusa

TRADITION
Maya, Mexican traditional medicine

CEREMONY / USE
Love magic, Venus ceremonies, sensual ritual

PROPERTIES
Flavonoids — mild aphrodisiac, nervine, mood-lifting

SPIRITUAL SIGNIFICANCE
Sacred to Ixchel (Maya moon goddess); opens the heart

Mugwort
Artemisia vulgaris

TRADITION
European witchcraft, East Asian, Native American

CEREMONY / USE
Dream work, divination, protection, moxibustion

PROPERTIES
Thujone — nervine, carminative, dream-intensifying

SPIRITUAL SIGNIFICANCE
Sacred to Artemis; the dreamer's herb, opens the veil

Kava
Piper methysticum

TRADITION
Pacific Islands — Melanesia, Polynesia, Micronesia

CEREMONY / USE
Welcoming ceremonies, conflict resolution, healing

PROPERTIES
Kavalactones — anxiolytic, muscle relaxant, euphoric

SPIRITUAL SIGNIFICANCE
Gift of the gods; unites community and dispels hostility

KEY OF USE

Smudge · Brew / Tea · Burning · Ingest / Consume · Dry · Offering / Ritual

Several plants featured are sacred to living indigenous cultures — approach with respect, reverence, and cultural humility.
Some are controlled substances in various jurisdictions — research local laws before any use or possession.

For educational reference only. Not medical or legal advice.